

PROJECT ATLAS

European AI Data Center Location Research Programme

SITE RESEARCH DOSSIER

As Pontes de García Rodríguez

Comarca do Eume • Province of A Coruña • Galicia • Spain

Document class	Gate 1 due diligence dossier (desk screening)
Objective	Determine whether the location should advance to Gate 2 or be rejected. The objective is not to prove the site is good.
Method	Falsification-first research; four-tier claim classification; primary-source preference (TSO, ministries, hydrological and environmental authorities, official gazettes).
Report date	4 August 2026
Version	1.0 (supersedes conversational summary of same date)
Gate decision proposed	CONTINUE RESEARCHING — do not advance, do not reject. Binary advancement condition defined in Section 19.
Prepared by	Atlas Research Desk (AI-assisted); requires human review before any external use or capital decision.

Headline finding. The single load-bearing assumption behind this site — that a dismantled 2.2 GW generation complex implies available grid capacity for a hyperscale demand facility — is currently **contradicted** by the primary record. The historic 400 kV node’s access capacity has been formally declared null, and the replacement capacity now being created at Maciñeira 400 kV is being auctioned to *generation* (renewables and storage), not allocated to demand. Everything published in favour of As Pontes as a data center hub is, to date, promotional language by the incumbent utility rather than an allocation, a connection permit, or a tender.

Document Control & Reading Guide

Classification system

Every material statement carries one of five labels. The label is part of the finding: the confidence structure of the whole case should be reconstructible from labels alone.

Label	Meaning	Decision weight
[VERIFIED]	Supported by a primary source (official act, regulator, operator, gazette) or by multiple concordant reputable secondary sources retrieved during this research pass.	May be relied upon at Gate 1. Re-verify at Gate 2 against the primary document itself where only secondary carriage was available.
[PARTIALLY VERIFIED]	Core fact verified; a material qualifier (date, magnitude, current status) is not.	Use with the stated qualifier only.
[HYPOTHESIS]	Plausible inference from verified facts or stable general knowledge; not independently confirmed in this pass.	May guide research priorities. Must not be underwritten.
[EVIDENCE REQUIRED]	A determinable fact that was not determined here; the retrieval path is known (named registry, authority, or dataset).	Blocks any conclusion that depends on it. Listed in the Unknowns Register with an owner.
[UNKNOWN]	Not determinable from public sources, or genuinely open (e.g. counterparty intent).	Treated as adverse until resolved, per Atlas conservatism rule.

Conservatism rules applied

- Proximity to infrastructure is never treated as availability of capacity. This rule is load-bearing for this specific site and is applied in Sections 6–7 without exception.
- Statements by commercially interested parties (the incumbent utility, developers, consultancies) are classified as verified *statements*, never as verified *facts* about capacity, cost, or timeline.
- Dated sources are treated as historical, with current status separately classified; mapping-derived distances and coordinates are marked approximate with explicit tolerances.
- An evidenced rejection is a successful outcome; nothing here advocates for the site.

Limitations of this pass

Desk research over public web sources, single session, 4 August 2026. No site visit and no counterparty contact (REE, Augas de Galicia, Concello, Endesa, carriers). Some primary acts are cited via reliable secondary carriage and must be pulled in original form at Gate 2 (Section 18.2). Cadastral, hydrological-permit and fibre-route data were not retrievable in this pass and are classified accordingly, not estimated.

How to read the dossier

Sections 1–5: identity and context. Sections 6–14: thematic screens. Sections 15–17: risk, unknowns and evidence. Sections 18–19: sources and the gate decision. Appendices A–E: regulatory frame, Gate 2 workplan, enquiry templates, glossary, assumption ledger. A ten-minute reader: Section 1, Section 6.4, Section 19.

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1. Executive Summary

1.1 Why this location entered the Atlas funnel

As Pontes de García Rodríguez hosted the largest coal-fired power station in Spain: four lignite/coal units totalling 1,468 MW plus an 800 MW combined-cycle gas turbine on the same complex. **[VERIFIED]** The coal units ceased producing electricity in October 2023 and the Spanish Government authorised the full closure in 2023; the four cooling towers were demolished by controlled blast in late July 2026 as part of the dismantling programme. **[VERIFIED]** The site therefore offers the canonical "re-powering" profile Atlas screens for: released heavy-industrial land at scale, extra-high-voltage assets physically in place, abundant regional water, a cool Atlantic climate, and an active state-led reindustrialisation framework (the "just transition" process). In February 2026 the CEO of Endesa publicly proposed As Pontes as a location for large data centers, citing sites, land and connections rarely available elsewhere, plus renewable generation potential in the surrounding area. **[VERIFIED]** (as a statement of commercial positioning, not as an allocation of anything).

1.2 Strongest verified advantages

- Legacy 400 kV transmission infrastructure physically present at and around the former plant, including the historic Puentes de García Rodríguez 400 kV node and the Maciñeira 400 kV substation incorporated into national planning. **[VERIFIED]**
- An active, funded, state-backed reindustrialisation machine: the Council of Ministers designated Maciñeira 400 kV a just-transition node on 14 April 2026, triggering a capacity concurso whose regulatory bases went to public consultation the same month. **[VERIFIED]**
- Exceptional regional freshwater endowment: the 865-hectare former mine-pit lake (maximum depth 206 m) immediately west of the town, the Eume reservoir (123 hm³) and the A Ribeira reservoir (33 hm³). Existence verified; availability for data-center use is a separate, unverified question. **[VERIFIED]** / **[EVIDENCE REQUIRED]**
- Oceanic climate with high free-cooling potential as a climate classification. **[VERIFIED]** Site-specific meteorological normals: **[EVIDENCE REQUIRED]**
- A usable fast-track permitting precedent in the same region: the Xunta granted "strategic industrial project" (PIE) status to the Curtis data center, accelerating urbanistic, environmental and sectoral processing. **[VERIFIED]**

1.3 The decisive unknowns

(U1) Demand-side grid capacity. Every published capacity instrument at this node concerns *generation* access (evacuation), not *demand* connection. The historic node's access capacity was formally declared null; the Maciñeira concurso awards capacity to renewables and storage. No public document reviewed in this pass allocates or even quantifies demand capacity at As Pontes for a large load. **[EVIDENCE REQUIRED]** This is the gate-blocking unknown; everything else is secondary until it resolves.

- (U2) Land control: which parcels, owned by whom (Endesa vs. municipality vs. third parties), with what urbanistic classification after demolition. **[EVIDENCE REQUIRED]**
- (U3) Water abstraction rights and — more binding — discharge permits, given the contested precedent of the Ence plant and the Fragas do Eume protected area downstream. **[EVIDENCE REQUIRED]**

REQUIRED]

- (U4) Fibre backbone routes, carrier presence, and physical redundancy at the site. No site-specific evidence was retrievable in this pass. [UNKNOWN]

1.4 Main failure modes

- **No demand capacity, none planned.** The node record points the wrong way for a load: access declared null; new capacity auctioned to generators; nationally, demand-access rights exceeding 43 GW have been granted since 2020 and Royal Decree-Law 7/2026 has just re-regulated demand access to curb hoarding — any Atlas application enters a contested, newly re-ruled queue. [VERIFIED]
- **Discharge refusal.** The Eume river system downstream is a Natural Park and Special Conservation Zone; the Ence project's discharge plan is already publicly contested for projected breaches of the Galicia-Costa Hydrological Plan quality standards. A wet-cooled data center would join that queue with a weaker socioeconomic narrative. [VERIFIED] (as to the conflict), [HYPOTHESIS] (as to Atlas' relative position).
- **Land gatekeeping.** Endesa may simultaneously be landowner, power counterparty and competing developer, controlling the entry path. [HYPOTHESIS]
- **Timeline risk.** The just-transition machinery is real but slow: the first Galician concurso (Meirama 220 kV, 408 MW) reached only provisional award years after the plant closure it responds to. [VERIFIED]

1.5 Gate status and recommendation

Current gate	Gate 1 — desk screening
Recommendation	CONTINUE RESEARCHING. Do not advance. Do not reject.
Binary advancement condition	Written confirmation from Red Eléctrica (or a MITECO planning document) of non-zero demand connection capacity, or a credible allocation pathway, of at least 100 MW at Puentes G.R. 400 kV / Maciñeira 400 kV within a defined horizon. A documented “no capacity and none planned” answer triggers rejection.
Spend rule	Until U1 clears, expenditure limited to the Gate 2 enquiry workplan in Appendix B; no land, legal or engineering commitments.

Full reasoning in Section 19.

2. Methodology & Research Protocol

2.1 The Atlas gate model

Atlas advances candidate locations through sequential gates, each of which exists to kill the project as cheaply as possible if it deserves killing. Gate 1 (this document) is a desk screen against public sources. Gate 2 is a formal-enquiry stage: written questions to the TSO, DSO, hydrological authority, planning authority and landowners, still without site commitments. Gate 3 is technical pre-feasibility (grid connection study, water balance, fibre RFI responses, environmental scoping). Gate 4 is commercial structuring. A location may be rejected at any gate; it may only advance one gate at a time; and no finding from a later gate may be assumed at an earlier one.

2.2 Source hierarchy

Tier	Source type	Examples used or targeted for this site
1	Official acts and primary operators	Council of Ministers agreements; MITECO/ITJ resolutions and consultations; BOE/DOG gazettes; Red Eléctrica planning and capacity publications; CNMC circulars; Augas de Galicia hydrological plan; Catastro; AEMET.
2	Reputable sector and general press carrying primary acts	DataCenterDynamics, pv magazine, elEconomista, sector legal notes (used where the primary PDF was not directly retrievable in this pass; each is flagged for Gate 2 primary retrieval).
3	Tertiary / community	Wikipedia, local associations. Used only for uncontested background (geography, plant history) and always labelled.

2.3 What was searched and what was not found

Searches were run in Spanish and English across: the just-transition node process for As Pontes / Maciñeira; data-center announcements and demand-access regulation in Galicia and Spain; the hydrology of the mine lake, the Eume river and its reservoirs; the Ence industrial precedent; the Fragas do Eume protected area; and Galician long-haul fibre and submarine-cable geography. Productive results are cited in the Evidence Register (Section 17). Two searched domains returned no site-specific primary evidence and are reported as such rather than filled by inference: (a) fibre routes, carriers and redundancy at As Pontes; (b) demand-side connection capacity figures at the two 400 kV substations. Their absence is itself a Gate 1 finding.

2.4 Handling of AI-assisted drafting

This dossier was drafted with AI assistance. Consistent with Atlas policy: no figure, date, name or legal reference appears unless it was either retrieved from a cited source in this session or is stable general knowledge explicitly labelled Hypothesis; approximate values carry tolerances; and the Unknowns Register (Section 16) is deliberately long. Human review is required before external use.

3. Location Identity & Exact Positioning

3.1 Administrative identity

Attribute	Value	Classification
Municipality (concello)	As Pontes de García Rodríguez (Spanish exonym: Puentes de García Rodríguez)	[VERIFIED]
Comarca	Comarca do Eume	[VERIFIED]
Province	A Coruña	[VERIFIED]
Autonomous community	Galicia	[VERIFIED]
Country / NUTS	Spain; NUTS-3 ES111 (A Coruña)	[VERIFIED]
INE municipal code	Not confirmed in this pass — retrieve from INE municipal register	[EVIDENCE REQUIRED]
Population	Approx. 10,000 inhabitants (order of magnitude, per municipal register history; exact current figure to be pulled from INE)	[HYPOTHESIS]
Just-transition zone	As Pontes zone: 14 municipalities — As Pontes, As Somozas, A Capela, Cabanas, Cerdido, Ferrol, Mañón, Moeche, Monfero, Ortigueira and San Sadurniño (A Coruña); Muras, Vilalba and Xermade (Lugo)	[VERIFIED]

3.2 Coordinates of the assets of interest

Atlas policy: coordinates below are derived from public mapping and gazetteer data, not from cadastral or survey documents. They are adequate for orientation and for drafting formal enquiries, and inadequate for land or engineering decisions. Tolerances are stated per row. Datum: WGS84.

Asset	Approx. coordinates (WGS84)	Tolerance	Classification
Town centre, As Pontes	43.450° N, 7.852° W	± 500 m	[HYPOTHESIS] (gazetteer)
Former thermal plant complex (demolition site)	≈ 43.44° N, 7.86° W — immediately south-east of the town core	± 1 km	[HYPOTHESIS]
Endesa Termic chimney (356 m stack, built 1974)	Within the plant complex above; individual stack coordinates not survey-verified	± 1 km	[PARTIALLY VERIFIED] (height/date verified)
Mine-pit lake (Lago de As Pontes)	≈ 43.43° N, 7.90° W — body extends ~5 km, west of the town	± 1 km (centroid)	[PARTIALLY VERIFIED] (dimensions verified)
Puentes G.R. 400 kV substation	At/adjacent to the plant complex; exact yard coordinates to be taken from REE mapping	n/a	[EVIDENCE REQUIRED]
Maciñeira 400 kV substation	Maciñeira area of As Pontes municipality; exact coordinates to be taken from the planning modification / REE	n/a	[EVIDENCE REQUIRED]
Eume reservoir dam	On the Eume cañón downstream (municipalities A Capela / As Pontes / Monfero); dam 101 m high, 284 m long	n/a	[PARTIALLY VERIFIED] (dam data verified)

Gate 2 action: replace this table with survey-grade coordinates from Catastro, the REE transmission map, and the Maciñeira planning modification annex.

3.3 Distances and orientation

Road distances below are approximate driving distances read from public mapping; they have not been verified against a routing engine in this pass and carry a tolerance of roughly $\pm 15\%$. All are classified **[HYPOTHESIS]** unless noted.

Destination	Approx. road distance	Relevance
Ferrol (city / naval & industrial hub)	≈ 35–45 km	Nearest city; port; engineering campus of Universidade da Coruña
Outer Port of Ferrol (Cabo Prioriño)	≈ 45–55 km	Deep-water port referenced in the transition plan for industrial/logistics uses (linkage [VERIFIED])
A Coruña (city)	≈ 60–75 km	Provincial capital; airport (Alvedro); university (UDC main campus)
Santiago de Compostela	≈ 90–110 km	Regional capital; airport; USC university
Lugo	≈ 65–80 km	Secondary labour market
Curtis-Teixeiro industrial estate	≈ 55–75 km	Site of Galicia's first announced data center (Section 14)
Madrid (interconnection ecosystem)	≈ 550–600 km	Nearest major internet-exchange and cloud-region ecosystem — relevant to Section 9

3.4 Physical setting

The municipality sits in the interior uplands of northern A Coruña province, in the valley system of the Eume river, which rises in the Serra do Xistral (peaks above 1,000 m) and runs roughly 80 km to the Atlantic at the ría de Ares. **[VERIFIED]** The town lies at an elevation of roughly 300–350 m above sea level. **[HYPOTHESIS]** The landscape is a mosaic of the reclaimed mining void (now the lake), the former external spoil heap (revegetated; a published zoological study recorded 172 vertebrate species on it), industrial platforms, the town, and Atlantic upland pasture and forestry. **[PARTIALLY VERIFIED]** Part of the Fragas do Eume Natural Park falls within the municipality itself, downstream of the industrial zone — a fact with direct permitting consequences developed in Section 11. **[VERIFIED]**

4. Site & Land Assessment

4.1 The candidate land envelope

No specific parcel has been nominated by Atlas or by any counterparty; this dossier therefore assesses a land *envelope* rather than a site. The envelope comprises: (a) the platforms being released by the demolition of the thermal plant, which Endesa and reporting on the demolition state are destined for new industrial uses within the town's economic transition **[VERIFIED]**; (b) adjacent industrial land in the municipality (including the Penapurreira industrial estate — existence **[HYPOTHESIS]**, to be confirmed against the municipal plan); and (c) reclaimed mining land around the lake, part of which has already been allocated to the Ence recycled-fibre plant on the former mining settling basin. **[VERIFIED]**

4.2 Ownership and control

The thermal plant and mine were developed and operated by Endesa, and the demolition is being executed by Endesa; it is therefore reasonable to expect Endesa (or group vehicles) to hold most of the released land. **[HYPOTHESIS]** Actual ownership, encumbrances, concession reversion clauses (the original water concession dates to 1953 **[VERIFIED]**), and any commitments already made to third parties (Ence; others) are undetermined. **[EVIDENCE REQUIRED]** The dual role of Endesa — landowner, grid-adjacent incumbent, prospective power counterparty, and public promoter of the data-center concept — creates an obvious gatekeeping risk (Risk R2, Section 15).

4.3 Cadastral and urbanistic status

Item	Status	Gate 2 retrieval path
Cadastral references of candidate parcels	[EVIDENCE REQUIRED]	Sede Electrónica del Catastro (parcel query over the plant platform and adjacent estates)
Registered ownership & charges	[EVIDENCE REQUIRED]	Registro de la Propiedad (nota simple per parcel)
Municipal zoning (PXOM) classification of released land	[EVIDENCE REQUIRED]	PXOM of As Pontes via Concello / Xunta urbanism portal (SIOTUGA)
Whether demolition triggers reclassification or remediation conditions	[UNKNOWN]	Demolition authorisation file (industry authority) + soil quality declarations (Xunta environment)
Soil condition / contamination of former coal yards and ash-handling areas	[EVIDENCE REQUIRED] — assume adverse until reports obtained	Declaración de calidad del suelo files; Endesa dismantling EIA

4.4 Precedents on the same land

The Ence project is the controlling precedent for how this land is being allocated: a recycled-fibre (tissue pulp) plant sited on the former mining settling basin, within an announced investment plan of €355 million, producing around 100,000 t/year of bleached recycled fibre, with a favourable environmental declaration (DIA) issued by the Xunta and active opposition from the environmental group ADEGA over its water take and discharges. **[VERIFIED]** Two lessons transfer directly: land on the complex *can* be obtained by industrial newcomers; and the water/discharge file, not the land file, is where the fight happens.

4.5 Heritage and demolition politics

The demolition has not been consensual. The BNG (Galician nationalist party) in As Pontes demanded preservation of part of the complex — two cooling towers, the chimney, a boiler, and the turbine and control halls — as an electricity museum and energy research centre; the blast proceeded regardless in late July 2026. **[VERIFIED]** No formal heritage protection over remaining elements (notably the 356 m chimney, the second-tallest in Europe **[VERIFIED]**) was identified in this pass. **[EVIDENCE REQUIRED]** Residual risk: late heritage-listing initiatives complicating site layout or demolition of remaining structures (Risk R4).

5. Industrial History & Transition Context

5.1 Why history matters at this site

As Pontes is not a greenfield: it is a single-company town whose economy, land tenure, water rights, grid topology and politics were all shaped by one asset over five decades. Every Atlas workstream at this site inherits that structure. The condensed history below is assembled from the sources in Section 18 and from stable public record; items marked otherwise are classified inline.

5.2 Timeline

Period	Event	Classification
1953	Water concession on the Eume granted for the industrial development (predates ecological-flow obligations, per later Xunta statements)	[VERIFIED]
Mid-1970s	Coal plant enters operation (first units, 1976 per environmental declaration); 356 m chimney built 1974	[VERIFIED]
1976–2007	Local lignite mining feeds the plant; open pit and external spoil heap transform the valley; plant reaches 1,468 MW across four units and becomes Spain's largest coal station and its top CO ₂ emitter	[VERIFIED]
2008 (approx.)	800 MW combined-cycle gas plant commissioned alongside the coal units, sharing site infrastructure	[PARTIALLY VERIFIED] (existence and 800 MW verified; commissioning year approximate)
2008–2012	Mine void flooded: Eume diversions averaging ~96 hm ³ /year via a 3,335 m canal, plus ~21 hm ³ /yr pit runoff and ~24 hm ³ /yr spoil-heap water; filling completed in ~3.7 years; lake connects to the Eume at level 332 m	[VERIFIED] (2010–11 sources; dated)
2019–2020	Endesa requests closure of the coal plant; loss of coal competitiveness vs. gas and CO ₂ prices	[VERIFIED]
2022	Closure interrupted: partial reopening amid the European gas crisis following the invasion of Ukraine	[VERIFIED]
Aug–Oct 2023	Government authorises full closure (BOE reference BOE-A-2023-18538, cited via tertiary source — pull original); production ceases October 2023	[PARTIALLY VERIFIED]
2023–2026	Dismantling proceeds; Ence plant announced on released land (€355M plan); Endesa CEO publicly proposes As Pontes for data centers (Feb 2026)	[VERIFIED]
14 Apr 2026	Council of Ministers declares Maciñeira 400 kV a just-transition node; the historic node's access capacity being null, Maciñeira had been added to the 2021–2026 planning by modification	[VERIFIED]
Apr–May 2026	ITJ opens prior public consultation on the concurso regulatory bases; submissions until 19 May 2026	[VERIFIED]
Late Jul 2026	Controlled blast demolishes the four cooling towers (~1.2 seconds); land destined for new industrial uses	[VERIFIED]

5.3 The just-transition machinery

Spain's just-transition node mechanism (introduced by Royal Decree-Law 23/2020, as referenced by the Instituto para la Transición Justa — statute number to be confirmed against BOE at Gate 2)

auctions the grid access capacity freed by closed thermal plants to new renewable and storage projects, scored not only technically but on socioeconomic criteria: employment (with special attention to surplus coal workers and women), training, self-consumption, and associated industrial projects and local investment. **[PARTIALLY VERIFIED]** The As Pontes concurso will be the second in Galicia. The first — Meirama 220 kV — provisionally awarded its 408 MW to Coventina Renovables for a pumped-storage hydro plant with an investment near €250 million and local-benefit commitments. **[VERIFIED]**

Implication for Atlas. The mechanism is real, funded and politically backed — and it is built around *generation*. A data center can plausibly enter it only sideways: as the "associated industrial project" that strengthens a generation bidder's socioeconomic score, or as an off-taker (PPA anchor) for the winning renewables. Both routes exist on paper; neither has been tested for a data center at this node. **[HYPOTHESIS]** / **[DECISION PENDING]**

6. Power — Grid Access & Capacity

This is the decisive section of the dossier. Atlas rule applied throughout: proximity to infrastructure is never treated as available capacity.

6.1 Grid actors

Role	Entity	Classification
Transmission System Operator (TSO) and transmission owner	Red Eléctrica de España (Redeia group) — statutory single TSO of Spain	[VERIFIED]
Distribution System Operator (DSO) in the area	Expected: UFD Distribución Electricidad (Naturgy group), the dominant Galician distributor, which has announced €520M of Galician network investment to 2029 (42% of its national grid budget). Confirmation that UFD serves the specific parcels: outstanding.	[PARTIALLY VERIFIED]
Planning authority for grid	MITECO (Secretaría de Estado de Energía) via the binding national electricity planning; CNMC as regulator (remuneration, access rules)	[VERIFIED]
Just-transition capacity administrator	Instituto para la Transición Justa (ITJ), MITECO	[VERIFIED]

6.2 Transmission assets at the site

Two extra-high-voltage substations define the node: the historic **Puentes de García Rodríguez 400 kV** substation, to which the thermal plant was connected, and **Maciñeira 400 kV**, incorporated into the national planning by modification precisely because the historic node had no access capacity left. [VERIFIED] The 400 kV corridor that evacuated up to ~2.2 GW of thermal generation from this valley physically exists; its lines, their current thermal ratings, and their post-closure loading are not published at the level of detail needed here. [EVIDENCE REQUIRED] Lower-voltage (220 kV / 132 kV / distribution) topology around the town: [EVIDENCE REQUIRED] (REE map + UFD network data).

6.3 The capacity record — what is actually published

#	Published fact	Source class	Classification
F1	The thermal plant connected to the Puentes G.R. 400 kV node, whose access capacity is null ("ser nula su capacidad de acceso").	Council of Ministers / MITECO via press	[VERIFIED]
F2	To remedy F1, the Government modified the 2021–2026 Electricity Planning to incorporate the Maciñeira 400 kV substation, to allow connection of new renewables and storage and to favour supply to new industrial projects.	Same	[VERIFIED]
F3	On 14 April 2026 Maciñeira 400 kV was declared a just-transition node; its access capacity will be awarded by concurso to renewables and storage projects scored on socioeconomic and environmental criteria.	Council of Ministers; MITECO press release 23 Apr 2026	[VERIFIED]
F4	The prior public consultation on the concurso bases opened April 2026, submissions until 19 May 2026. The MW volume to be auctioned was not stated in the materials retrieved.	MITECO / sector press	[VERIFIED] (process); volume [EVIDENCE REQUIRED]

#	Published fact	Source class	Classification
F5	Precedent: Meirama 220 kV concurso — 408 MW provisionally awarded to a pumped-storage hydro project (~€250M).	ITJ via MITECO	[VERIFIED]
F6	Nationally, demand access rights granted since 2020 exceed 43 GW — above Spain's 2024 peak demand of 38.2 GW; in the draft planning to 2030, demand is 41% of access requests; 27.7 GW of demand is to be served from transmission, of which 3.8 GW is earmarked for data centers, within €13.59bn of transmission investment.	MITECO figures via sector press	[VERIFIED] (as reported; draft plan)
F7	MITECO estimates Galician networks' additional capacity for new consumption will roughly double the 2.2 GW regional demand peak by end of decade — contained in the <i>proposed</i> Planificación, not an approved plan.	MITECO via sector press	[HYPOTHESIS] until plan approval
F8	Royal Decree-Law 7/2026 (20 March 2026; in force 22 March 2026) introduced measures on grid access aimed at optimising use of existing networks and reducing hoarding of demand access.	Legal analysis of RD-L 7/2026	[VERIFIED] (BOE original to be pulled)
F9	CNMC (Dec 2025) set the financial remuneration rate for networks at 6.58% for 2026–2031 and maintained the remunerable investment cap at 0.13% of GDP — a structural brake on how fast reinforcement can be built.	Sector press citing CNMC	[VERIFIED] (as reported)

6.4 The demand-capacity gap (gate-blocking finding)

Read together, F1–F5 describe a node whose freed capacity is being recycled into **generation**. A data center is a **demand** facility; its connection follows the demand access-and-connection procedure (Ley 24/2013 framework; RD 1183/2020; CNMC access circular; now overlaid by RD-L 7/2026), addressed to the TSO/DSO, with capacity determined by REE's demand capacity publications and, increasingly, by planning allocations. **No document retrieved in this pass states any demand connection capacity figure — zero or otherwise — at Puentes G.R. 400 kV or Maciñeira 400 kV. [EVIDENCE REQUIRED]** The frequently heard shorthand “the plant is gone, so 2 GW of grid is free” is not supported by anything published: evacuation capacity freed by a generator does not convert automatically into demand connection capacity, the historic node's access was declared null, and the new capacity is being auctioned to generators. Until REE answers a formal enquiry, the honest statement is: **demand capacity at this node is unknown, and the visible record leans adverse.**

6.5 Plausible entry routes for a large load (untested)

- **Route A — straight demand application** under the general access regime to Maciñeira/Puentes 400 kV, under RD-L 7/2026 rules. Fate depends entirely on the unpublished demand headroom and on the (draft) planning's Galician demand allocations. **[DECISION PENDING]**
- **Route B — planning allocation:** secure a named or zonal demand allocation in the final Planificación 2026/2030 (which explicitly contemplates 3.8 GW for data centers nationally from transmission). Requires engagement in the planning approval process; timing driven by BOE approval date. **[HYPOTHESIS]**
- **Route C — just-transition association:** partner with a concurso bidder as the associated industrial project / PPA anchor that lifts their socioeconomic score, and negotiate connection alongside. Legally plausible under the concurso criteria; never yet done for a data center at a Galician node. **[HYPOTHESIS]**

- **Route D — Endesa-led scheme:** enter whatever structure Endesa itself is designing for the released land (its CEO's framing pairs data centers with long-term PPAs anchoring new renewables). Existence of an actual scheme, RFP or timeline: **[UNKNOWN]**

6.6 Section risks and unknowns (feed into Sections 15–16)

R1 (no demand capacity), R5 (queue congestion / rule change), R8 (planning not approved as proposed); U1 (demand headroom), U5 (Endesa masterplan), U7 (final planning content). The section conclusion is deliberately narrow: the power case is neither established nor excluded — it is undetermined, and it is the first thing Gate 2 must determine.

7. Energy — Generation Mix, Renewables & Carbon

7.1 Generation on and around the site

On-site thermal generation has ended: coal production ceased October 2023 and the plant is in physical dismantling. **[VERIFIED]** The 800 MW combined-cycle unit was built alongside the coal plant and shared its infrastructure; its operational status in 2026 (operating, mothballed, or in closure procedure) was not confirmed in this pass. **[EVIDENCE REQUIRED]** The Eume reservoir feeds what is described as the most powerful hydroelectric plant in A Coruña province, downstream in the cañón. **[PARTIALLY VERIFIED]** (description verified; MW figure not retrieved).

7.2 Renewable pipeline

The transition plan around the closure contemplates wind and hybrid renewable projects replacing the ~1,400 MW thermal role, with large data centers explicitly framed by Endesa as priority candidates for long-term PPAs that would anchor those renewable investments. **[VERIFIED]** (as stated intent). Galicia generally, and the Xistral/Ferrolterra uplands specifically, are established wind country; project-level status of the As Pontes-area pipeline (permits, MW, CODs) was not compiled in this pass. **[EVIDENCE REQUIRED]** The Maciñeira concurso will itself create new local generation and storage whose volume is not yet public. **[EVIDENCE REQUIRED]**

7.3 Curtailment and system conditions

Galicia is structurally a renewables-exporting region; northwest curtailment statistics, nodal prices and constraint patterns were not retrieved and are genuinely material to an AI-load business case (flexible loads monetise curtailment). **[EVIDENCE REQUIRED]** (ESIOS/REE datasets). System-stability regulation is in flux following the April 2025 Iberian blackout; implications for the connection conditions of very large flexible loads in weakly-loaded corridors: **[EVIDENCE REQUIRED]**.

7.4 Carbon and PPA considerations

A credible low-carbon supply narrative exists on paper: new local wind/storage from the concurso plus incumbent appetite for anchor PPAs. **[HYPOTHESIS]** Two cautions. First, the narrative currently originates almost entirely from the party that would sell the power. Second, Endesa itself publicly hedges: deployment of new renewables and of large consumers such as data centers remains conditioned by regulatory uncertainty and grid-planning timelines — a notable caveat from the promoter. **[VERIFIED]**

8. Water — Sources, Rights & Discharge

8.1 Physical endowment

Body	Key verified data	Notes / classification
Lago de As Pontes (mine-pit lake)	865 ha surface; ~5 km long; maximum depth 206 m; filled 2008–2012 with Eume diversions (~96 hm ³ /yr average during filling) plus pit runoff (~21 hm ³ /yr) and spoil-heap water (~24 hm ³ /yr); connects to the Eume at level 332; water quality described as comparable to natural waters with ~2,000 controls/year during filling	[VERIFIED] — but sources are 2010–2011; current limnology, quality and management regime [EVIDENCE REQUIRED]
Eume reservoir	123 hm ³ capacity; dam 101 m high / 284 m long (built 1955–1960); spans A Capela, As Pontes and Monfero; feeds the province's most powerful hydro plant	[VERIFIED]
A Ribeira reservoir	33 hm ³ capacity, upstream near the industrial valley	[VERIFIED]
Eume river	Rises in Serra do Xistral; ~80 km to the ría de Ares; ecological flow obligations discussed publicly since at least 2010 in connection with the 1953 concession	[VERIFIED]

8.2 Rights and governance

The competent authority is Augas de Galicia under the Plan Hidrológico Galicia-Costa 2021–2027. **[VERIFIED]** (plan's existence and use as the quality benchmark in the Ence dispute). Who currently holds abstraction rights over the lake and how the 1953 Endesa concession has been transformed post-closure is undetermined and is the pivotal legal question for any cooling design. **[EVIDENCE REQUIRED]** Municipal intent that lake water serve industrial and tourism uses is on record from the filling era. **[VERIFIED]** (2011; dated).

8.3 The Ence precedent — the controlling data point

The Ence plant will capture nearly 5,000 m³/day from the lake and will generate about 1.55 million m³/year of high-organic-load wastewater; ADEGA argues that even after treatment, parameters including pH, suspended solids, biological oxygen demand and heavy metals would fail the Eume's quality standards under the Galicia-Costa plan, and criticises Ence's proposal to resolve this by dilution into the Eume rather than discharge to the mining basin. The Xunta nonetheless issued a favourable DIA. **[VERIFIED]** Readings for Atlas: (i) abstraction from the lake at industrial scale is permissible in practice; (ii) discharge toward the Eume is the contested bottleneck and draws organised opposition; (iii) a data center arriving after Ence competes for the same assimilative capacity of the same small river with a weaker jobs narrative. **[HYPOTHESIS]** (the reading, not the facts).

8.4 Cooling-design consequences

- Evaporative/open-loop designs that discharge to the Eume system: highest permitting risk; assume adverse. **[HYPOTHESIS]**
- Closed-loop liquid cooling with lake-water heat rejection (withdraw/return to the lake itself, exploiting its 206 m depth and thermal mass): physically attractive and avoids the river; legal and limnological feasibility untested. **[DECISION PENDING]**

- Air-cooled / dry-cooler designs leveraging the mild Atlantic climate: minimises the water file at a density/efficiency cost; the climate makes this more viable here than in most of Iberia. **[HYPOTHESIS]** pending AEMET normals.
- Potable/municipal supply for domestic loads only; municipal WWTP capacity unknown. **[UNKNOWN]**

8.5 Drought and climate-change exposure

Northern Galicia is among the wettest regions of Spain and the site sits beside extraordinary stored volumes; prima facie drought exposure is low. **[HYPOTHESIS]** This must be replaced at Gate 2 by the Galicia-Costa drought indicator system and any climate projections for the Eume basin. **[EVIDENCE REQUIRED]**

9. Fibre & Connectivity

9.1 Honest headline

Targeted searches (Spanish and English) returned **no site-specific primary evidence** on backbone routes, carrier presence, duct availability or redundancy at As Pontes. This section therefore contains one verified comparator, a set of labelled hypotheses, and a retrieval plan — and nothing else. **[UNKNOWN]** as a domain.

9.2 What is verified (context, not site)

Iberian submarine-cable landings cluster away from Galicia: Sines (Portugal) hosts EllaLink and Medusa and anchors Start Campus' planned 495 MW data-center hub; other systems land at Sesimbra, Bilbao and the Mediterranean coast. **[VERIFIED]** No submarine cable landing in Galicia was identified in this pass — absence not proven, **[EVIDENCE REQUIRED]** (TeleGeography / MINECO registry check). The nearest major interconnection ecosystem (internet exchanges, cloud on-ramps, carrier hotels) is Madrid, roughly 550–600 km away. **[HYPOTHESIS]**

9.3 Working hypotheses to test

- Long-haul dark fibre likely follows the 400 kV corridor (Reintel, the Redeia fibre subsidiary, monetises OPGW on the transmission grid) and/or motorway/rail corridors (Lyntia and others). Presence, spare pairs and access points at As Pontes: untested. **[HYPOTHESIS]**
- Retail/metro networks: Telefónica and Galician operators presumably serve the town; irrelevant to hyperscale needs except as a signal of duct presence. **[HYPOTHESIS]**
- For AI-training workloads, latency to Madrid IXs is a secondary constraint versus power and cooling; the binding requirement is diverse physical routes at scale, which is exactly the untested item. **[HYPOTHESIS]**

9.4 Gate 2 retrieval plan

Question	Counterparty / dataset
Dark-fibre presence, spare capacity and access points along the 400 kV corridor through As Pontes	Reintel (RFI); REE OPGW map
Alternative long-haul routes (diversity) via AG-64 / rail / other corridors	Lyntia, Telefónica wholesale, Adamo wholesale (RFIs)
Any Galician submarine landing, existing or consented	TeleGeography; MINECO/SETELECO registries; port authorities
Public-network duct maps and shared-infrastructure registries	CNMC infrastructure database; Xunta broadband office
Latency and route-miles to Madrid ecosystems	Carrier RFI responses (measured, not modelled)

10. Planning & Permitting

10.1 Authorities and instruments

Layer	Authority / instrument	Classification
Municipal	Concello de As Pontes — municipal plan (PXOM), licences	[VERIFIED] (institutional); PXOM content [EVIDENCE REQUIRED]
Regional urbanism	Xunta de Galicia — land law, supra-municipal instruments, and the “strategic industrial project” (PIE) figure granting administrative priority and accelerated urbanistic, environmental and sectoral processing	[VERIFIED] (PIE effect, via Curtis precedent)
Environment	Xunta (regional EIA/DIA, as in the Ence case) and/or MITECO for state-competence projects; Natura 2000 assessment where applicable	[VERIFIED]
Water	Augas de Galicia — Plan Hidrológico Galicia-Costa 2021–2027; concessions and discharge authorisations	[VERIFIED]
Grid	MITECO planning; REE access; CNMC rules (Section 6)	[VERIFIED]

10.2 Protected areas and Natura 2000

The Fragas do Eume Natural Park — 9,125 ha of Atlantic riparian forest along the Eume valley, declared 1997, also a Special Conservation Zone (ZEC, Natura 2000), with fewer than 500 residents inside and the Caaveiro monastery at its heart — lies immediately downstream of the industrial valley and extends into As Pontes municipality itself. **[VERIFIED]** Consequences: any project affecting the Eume (discharges, flow, temperature) faces Natura 2000 appropriate-assessment logic; and organised, litigation-capable opposition (ADEGA and others) is already mobilised on exactly this interface by the Ence case. **[VERIFIED]** Other nearby protected or inventoried areas (Xistral ZEC to the north-east, wetland inventories, etc.): **[EVIDENCE REQUIRED]** (Xunta conservation cartography overlay).

10.3 Heritage

Industrial-heritage sensitivity is demonstrated (BNG museum proposal; public debate around the tower blast). **[VERIFIED]** No formal listing of remaining structures was identified; the 356 m chimney’s status matters for any layout that touches it. **[EVIDENCE REQUIRED]** Archaeological constraints on reclaimed mining land are presumptively low (the ground is anthropogenic) but unverified. **[HYPOTHESIS]**

10.4 Flood, wildfire, noise, seismic

Hazard	Current knowledge	Gate 2 source
Flood	Valley-floor and lake-margin location suggests non-trivial mapping questions; the lake’s designed connection to the Eume at level 332 defines part of the hydraulic regime. No ARPSI/official flood map consulted. [EVIDENCE REQUIRED]	MITECO SNCZI flood cartography; Augas de Galicia

Hazard	Current knowledge	Gate 2 source
Wildfire	Galicia has one of Europe's highest wildfire frequencies; a 2012 fire burned 750 ha inside Fragas do Eume itself. [VERIFIED] Site exposure depends on vegetation interface of the chosen parcel. [EVIDENCE REQUIRED]	Xunta PLADIGA statistics; parcel-level fuel mapping
Noise	Rural surroundings with a ~10,000-inhabitant town adjacent; Galician noise zoning for the parcels unknown. [UNKNOWN]	PXOM acoustic zoning; Decreto 106/2015 (to confirm)
Seismic	NW Iberia is low-seismicity in national terms. [HYPOTHESIS]	NCSE-02 / IGN hazard maps
Ground conditions	Parts of the envelope are made ground (spoil, platforms); geotechnics assumed adverse until proven. [HYPOTHESIS] (conservative)	Endesa dismantling/geotech files; site investigation at Gate 3

10.5 Political economy of permitting

Favourable structural forces: a region and state actively courting reindustrialisation of this exact valley; a Xunta fast-track (PIE) already exercised for a data center at Curtis; a just-transition scoring system that rewards associated industrial projects and local employment — a data center's permanent-jobs profile is modest, which weakens (not eliminates) its score in that logic. **[VERIFIED]** facts, **[HYPOTHESIS]** synthesis. Unfavourable: demonstrated ENGO mobilisation on the water interface; demonstrated heritage contestation; and the political expectation, set by the closure, that replacement projects deliver employment at scale.

11. Transport & Logistics

11.1 Road

The AG-64 autovía is understood to link the Ferrol area (AP-9 corridor) with Vilalba past As Pontes, giving dual-carriageway access toward the port, the AP-9 and the A-6/A-8 national axes. **[HYPOTHESIS]** (high confidence; confirm against the official road inventory at Gate 2). Internal access to the plant platforms was built for power-station logistics. **[HYPOTHESIS]**

11.2 Heavy / abnormal loads

The site historically received power-plant-scale components (boilers, generators, transformers), implying a proven abnormal-load route existed to the complex. **[HYPOTHESIS]** Whether that route survives demolition-era changes and current road administration rules must be re-established for transformer-class deliveries. **[EVIDENCE REQUIRED]**

11.3 Rail

No active rail service to As Pontes was identified; the nearest general-network railheads are in the Ferrol area (Iberian gauge plus the narrow-gauge coastal line). **[UNKNOWN]** / **[HYPOTHESIS]** — confirm with ADIF network statement. Rail is a nice-to-have, not a screen criterion, for data centers.

11.4 Port and airport

The Port of Ferrol — including its deep-water outer harbour — is explicitly referenced in the transition framing for industrial and logistics uses linked to the As Pontes reconversion. **[VERIFIED]** (linkage); capabilities for project-cargo (craneage, laydown, abnormal-load exit routes): **[EVIDENCE REQUIRED]** (Autoridad Portuaria Ferrol-San Cibrao). Airports: A Coruña (Alvedro) ≈ 60–75 km and Santiago ≈ 90–110 km. **[HYPOTHESIS]** (distances).

12. Climate & Natural Conditions

12.1 Classification and cooling logic

The site has an Atlantic oceanic climate (Köppen Cfb): mild, humid, small annual temperature amplitude, rare extreme heat. **[VERIFIED]** (as classification). At ~300–350 m elevation and ~25 km from the coast, summer peaks should sit well below Iberian interior values, implying a high share of free-cooling hours and strong dry-cooler economics. **[HYPOTHESIS]** A local advocacy article makes the same climatic argument for data-center reuse of the site (mild, stable temperatures, no major heatwaves) — directionally plausible, but a partisan source. **[VERIFIED]** (that the claim was made).

12.2 What must replace this at Gate 2

Parameter	Required dataset
Design dry-bulb / wet-bulb (0.4% / 1% ASHRAE-style percentiles)	AEMET station normals + hourly series for the nearest stations (identify: As Pontes area / Ferrolterra / Xistral)
Humidity profile (adiabatic and corrosion design)	Same hourly series
Wind regime (Atlantic storms; also relevant to PPA wind resource)	AEMET; Galician meteorological service (MeteoGalicia)
Extreme events history (heatwaves, cold snaps, storm damage)	AEMET climatological summaries
Climate projections for the Eume basin (water & cooling planning)	AEMET/MITECO escenarios-PNACC datasets

12.3 Natural hazards summary

Wildfire is the headline natural hazard (Section 10.4; 750 ha burned inside the adjacent natural park in 2012 **[VERIFIED]**); Atlantic storm wind and heavy rainfall are the operational nuisances; seismicity is low in national terms **[HYPOTHESIS]**; flood exposure is parcel-dependent and unmapped in this pass **[EVIDENCE REQUIRED]**.

13. Workforce & Ecosystem

13.1 Labour pools

Three pools are relevant. (1) The legacy industrial workforce released by the closure — electricians, mechanical fitters, control-room and O&M staff — whose re-employment is an explicit scoring criterion of the just-transition mechanism (special attention to surplus coal workers). **[VERIFIED]** (2) The Ferrolterra industrial basin (naval construction at Navantia, port industry) within commuting range. **[HYPOTHESIS]** (composition), **[VERIFIED]** (Navantia's presence in the area is established public record). (3) University output: Universidade da Coruña (including its Ferrol engineering campus), Universidade de Santiago and Universidade de Vigo. **[VERIFIED]** (institutions exist); graduate volumes in relevant disciplines: **[EVIDENCE REQUIRED]**.

13.2 Data-center ecosystem

Essentially nil today: the Curtis project is described as the first data center of its kind in Galicia. **[VERIFIED]** Atlas would be building an ecosystem (specialised M&E contractors, commissioning agents, operations talent), not joining one — a cost and timeline factor, partly offset by the transferability of power-plant O&M skills. **[HYPOTHESIS]**

13.3 Housing and services

A ~10,000-inhabitant town that has lost its anchor employer should have available housing stock and strong political appetite for incomers; both assumed, neither quantified. **[HYPOTHESIS]** / **[EVIDENCE REQUIRED]** (INE housing census; Concello).

14. Competitive Landscape

14.1 In Galicia

Galicia Green Data Center (Curtis-Teixeiro). Promoted via the public-private vehicle Impulsa Galicia and developed with Ingenostrum: Tier III, up to 15 MW IT, four parcels totalling over 40,000 m², budget above €50M (first phase €37M including urbanisation, offices and first data hall), plus an annexed transformer substation; granted “strategic industrial project” status by the Xunta. **[VERIFIED]** Strategically it is small — not an AI-scale competitor — but it establishes the permitting template, the political sponsorship, and a regional first-mover claim.

14.2 At As Pontes itself

The most likely large-scale mover is Endesa, whose CEO is publicly positioning the site for data centers paired with PPAs anchoring new renewables. **[VERIFIED]** (statements). Whether Endesa intends to develop, to sell serviced plots, to run an RFP, or merely to market power is unknown — and determines whether Endesa is Atlas’ landlord, supplier, partner or rival. **[UNKNOWN]** (feeds U5).

14.3 National and Iberian pressure

- Spain’s draft planning earmarks 3.8 GW of transmission-served demand for data centers nationally to 2030 — the competitive game is capture of that allocation. **[VERIFIED]** (draft figure).
- Developers announce capacity with power claimed as secured: e.g. Nostrum Data Centers, with JLL, plans six Spanish sites totalling 800 MW planned capacity (500 MW IT plus 300 MW reserved), operational through 2027, with supply and land described as already secured. **[VERIFIED]** (announcement; claims not independently verified). As Pontes starts behind such claims because its demand capacity is undefined.
- Iberian Atlantic comparator: Sines (Portugal) pairs submarine-cable landings (EllaLink, Medusa) with Start Campus’ planned 495 MW campus — structurally stronger connectivity on the same façade. **[VERIFIED]**
- Cloud regions: AWS operates its Spain region in Aragón; Madrid hosts the main hyperscale cluster; no cloud region exists in Galicia. **[HYPOTHESIS]** (high confidence; confirm trivially at Gate 2).

14.4 Competitive reading

As Pontes’ only durable competitive asset relative to the national field is the possibility — currently unproven — of very large, politically sponsored power at a re-powered node with abundant water and cool air. If U1 resolves positively, the site leapfrogs most announced projects on the two scarcest inputs (MW and cooling). If U1 resolves negatively, the site has no offsetting advantage: connectivity is unproven, ecosystem is absent, and the jobs-hungry politics prefer other industries. The competitive case is therefore an option on U1, which is precisely why the gate recommendation is to buy information, not land.

15. Risk Register

Conventions: Likelihood and Impact are qualitative (Low / Medium / High) at Gate 1 and will be quantified at Gate 3. “Confidence” rates the evidence base behind the risk description itself, not the risk’s probability. Impact ratings assume a 100+ MW AI-training campus as the reference project.

R1 — No demand-side grid capacity	Likelihood: High
Cause	The historic node’s access capacity was formally declared null; new Maciñeira capacity is being auctioned to generation (renewables/storage); no demand headroom figure is published for either 400 kV substation.
Impact	Fatal if confirmed: without a connection there is no project. Also fatal-in-practice if capacity exists only on a >6–7 year reinforcement horizon.
Likelihood detail	High that the risk is real (i.e. that capacity is undetermined-to-adverse); the underlying fact is resolvable by a single formal enquiry.
Evidence	Council of Ministers / MITECO acts of April 2026 (Section 6.3, F1–F4); absence of any demand figure in all retrieved material.
Mitigation	Immediate formal demand-access enquiry to REE (template, Appendix C1); engagement in the Planificación 2026/2030 approval process; explore concurso-association route (6.5-C) and Endesa-led route (6.5-D) in parallel.
Confidence in this entry	High
R2 — Land not controllable / gatekept	Likelihood: Medium
Cause	Endesa presumptively owns most released land and is itself promoting the data-center concept; parcels may already be committed (Ence precedent) or reserved for Endesa-aligned schemes; cadastral status unknown.
Impact	Fatal (no site) or severe (monopoly landlord pricing; loss of design freedom).
Likelihood detail	Medium — the Ence case shows land does get allocated to newcomers, but through bilateral processes Atlas does not yet have access to.
Evidence	Demolition-reuse reporting; Ence siting on the former settling basin; Endesa CEO statements (Sections 4–5).
Mitigation	Cadastral and registry due diligence (Appendix C2); direct approach to Endesa real-estate / transition team; parallel check of municipal and Xunta-controlled industrial land.
Confidence in this entry	Low — little hard data yet

R3 — Water discharge refusal or restriction	Likelihood: Medium
Cause	Eume quality standards under the Galicia-Costa plan; Natura 2000 ZEC and Natural Park immediately downstream; organised ENGO opposition already litigating the interface via the Ence case; assimilative capacity partly consumed by Ence's permitted discharge.
Impact	Blocks evaporative and any river-discharging design; forces dry or lake-loop cooling with cost/density penalties; schedule risk from contested EIA.
Likelihood detail	Medium for lake-loop designs; High for river-discharge designs.
Evidence	Ence DIA controversy with quantified abstraction (5,000 m³/day) and discharge (1.55 hm³/yr) figures (Section 8.3).
Mitigation	Design out the river: closed-loop with lake heat rejection or dry cooling; early scoping meeting with Augas de Galicia (Appendix C3); commission limnological study of the lake's heat-sink capacity.
Confidence in this entry	Medium
R4 — Permitting and political friction	Likelihood: Medium
Cause	Heritage contestation (BNG museum campaign); just-transition politics that price projects in jobs, where data centers score modestly; possible late heritage-listing of the chimney or other remnants.
Impact	Delay of 1–3 years; conditions attached (employment, training, local investment commitments); reputational friction.
Likelihood detail	Medium.
Evidence	Verified BNG campaign and demolition politics (Section 4.5); concurso scoring criteria (Section 5.3).
Mitigation	Pursue Xunta PIE status early (Curtis precedent); voluntary local-benefit package (training academy with UDC-Ferrol; district-heat offer to town/industry from waste heat); position Atlas as PPA anchor enabling the concurso's renewables jobs.
Confidence in this entry	Medium

R5 — Demand-access queue congestion and regulatory instability	Likelihood: High
Cause	>43 GW of demand access granted nationally since 2020; demand now 41% of planning requests; RD-L 7/2026 rewrote demand-access rules mid-game to curb hoarding and may be further developed by secondary regulation.
Impact	Queue position loss; changed guarantee/milestone requirements; capacity awarded to faster-moving or better-connected applicants.
Likelihood detail	High that the environment stays congested and rule-shifting through 2027.
Evidence	MITECO figures and RD-L 7/2026 (Section 6.3, F6–F8).
Mitigation	Apply early under the new rules with clean, credible milestones; maintain regulatory watch; size guarantees into budget; avoid speculative-looking multi-node applications that the anti-hoarding rules target.
Confidence in this entry	Medium-High
R6 — Connectivity inadequate or expensive	Likelihood: Unknown
Cause	No verified backbone presence, route diversity or duct availability at the site; Galicia lacks (as far as this pass shows) submarine landings and internet exchanges.
Impact	Limits addressable workloads toward latency-tolerant AI training; possible material capex for new long-haul builds to Madrid/Bilbao/Portugal ecosystems.
Likelihood detail	Cannot be rated — the domain is unresearched (deliberately flagged rather than guessed).
Evidence	Section 9: absence of findings after targeted search.
Mitigation	Reintel/Lyntia/Telefónica RFIs (Appendix C4) before any further site spend; treat a single-route answer as a red flag.
Confidence in this entry	Low
R7 — Wildfire exposure	Likelihood: Low-Medium
Cause	High regional wildfire frequency; forest/scrub interface around reclaimed land; 2012 fire burned 750 ha inside the adjacent natural park.
Impact	Service interruption (smoke ingress, grid line trips), insurance loading, worker safety episodes; unlikely to threaten hardened structures directly.
Likelihood detail	Low–Medium depending on parcel vegetation interface.
Evidence	Verified 2012 Fragas fire; regional fire statistics (to be pulled: PLADIGA).
Mitigation	Defensible-space landscaping; underground utility entries; N+1 air filtration with smoke mode; coordination with Xunta fire services.
Confidence in this entry	Medium

R8 — Grid reinforcement plans not delivered as drafted	Likelihood: Medium
Cause	The favourable Galician demand-capacity outlook sits in a proposed (not approved) Planificación; CNMC's 0.13%-of-GDP remunerable-investment cap and 6.58% rate constrain build-out speed; political cycles can reshape the plan.
Impact	The “capacity will double by 2030” premise slips right; Atlas timelines built on it collapse.
Likelihood detail	Medium.
Evidence	Draft-plan status and CNMC parameters (Section 6.3, F7/F9).
Mitigation	Underwrite nothing on the draft; track BOE approval as a named gate condition; structure any land options with planning-approval contingencies.
Confidence in this entry	Medium
R9 — Counterparty concentration on Endesa	Likelihood: Medium
Cause	One company may control land, legacy assets, water-adjacent rights, PPA supply and the political narrative for this site.
Impact	Negotiating asymmetry across every workstream simultaneously; project becomes an Endesa-terms project or does not happen.
Likelihood detail	Medium–High if Atlas proceeds bilaterally; reducible via the public routes (concurso association, planning allocation, municipal/Xunta land).
Evidence	Sections 4–6; Endesa's public positioning.
Mitigation	Keep two independent paths alive at all times (public-land + public-capacity route vs. Endesa route); never let exclusivity be a precondition of information.
Confidence in this entry	Medium
R10 — Dated environmental baseline data	Likelihood: Medium
Cause	Key lake and water facts date from 2010–2011 filling-era sources; limnology, quality and governance may have evolved materially over 15 years.
Impact	Cooling designs premised on stale data fail EIA scrutiny; rework.
Likelihood detail	Medium.
Evidence	Source dating flagged in Sections 5.2 and 8.1 and the Evidence Register.
Mitigation	Commission/obtain current lake monitoring data (Endesa handover files; Augas de Galicia) as a Gate 2 deliverable.
Confidence in this entry	High (that the data is dated is certain)

Portfolio view

R1 dominates: it is binary, cheap to resolve, and everything else is conditional on it. R2/R9 (land/counterparty) and R3 (discharge) are the second tier — serious but design- and structure-addressable. R5/R8 are environment risks Atlas shares with every Spanish applicant. R6 is an information gap masquerading as a risk. No risk identified at Gate 1 is both unresolvable and fatal — which is exactly why the recommendation is to continue researching rather than reject.

16. Unknowns Register

Every item below currently prevents advancement to Gate 2 sign-off or beyond. “Blocking level”: GATE = blocks the gate decision itself; DESIGN = blocks engineering choices; COMMERCIAL = blocks structuring. Owner actions correspond to the workplan in Appendix B and the templates in Appendix C.

#	Unknown	Blocking	Resolution path	Target
U1	Demand connection capacity (MW) and timeline at Puentes G.R. 400 kV / Maciñeira 400 kV; applicable procedure post RD-L 7/2026	GATE	Formal enquiry to REE + REE demand-capacity map + MITECO planning annexes (Appendix C1)	Gate 2, week 1–6
U2	Parcel identification: cadastral references, ownership, charges, zoning (PXOM) and soil condition of the released platforms	GATE	Catastro + Registro de la Propiedad + PXOM/SIOTUGA + soil-quality files (Appendix C2)	Gate 2, week 1–8
U3	Water: current lake governance, abstraction-rights status of the 1953 concession post-closure, discharge options and their Natura 2000 exposure	GATE / DESIGN	Augas de Galicia pre-application meeting + Ence DIA full text from DOG (Appendix C3)	Gate 2, week 2–10
U4	Fibre: backbone presence, spare pairs, route diversity, build cost to Madrid/other ecosystems	DESIGN	RFIs to Reintel, Lyntia, Telefónica wholesale (Appendix C4); CNMC infrastructure registry	Gate 2, week 2–10
U5	Endesa's actual masterplan for the released land: develop / sell plots / RFP / power-only; decision timeline	COMMERCIAL	Direct engagement; monitor ITJ and Endesa announcements	Gate 2, continuous
U6	Environmental & hazard baselines: AEMET normals; SNCZI flood mapping; wildfire hazard for candidate parcels; current lake limnology	DESIGN	AEMET, MITECO SNCZI, Xunta PLADIGA; Endesa monitoring handover	Gate 2–3
U7	Final approved content of Planificación 2026/2030 for NW Galicia (demand allocations, reinforcement list, dates)	GATE (timing)	Track BOE; participate in consultation if window remains	External milestone
U8	CCGT (800 MW) status and its interaction with node capacity and site layout	DESIGN	REE enquiry response; Endesa; MITECO closure files	Gate 2
U9	Concurso design for Maciñeira: MW volume, criteria weighting, whether demand-side association is scoreable, calendar	GATE (route C)	ITJ publications following the May 2026 consultation	External milestone
U10	Municipal and Xunta position on a hyperscale campus specifically (vs. industry generally): jobs expectations, PIE appetite	COMMERCIAL	Meetings with Concello de As Pontes and Xunta (Igape / economic vice-presidency)	Gate 2, week 4–12
U11	Whether any competing data-center application already sits in the demand queue at this node	GATE	REE enquiry response; RD-L 7/2026 transparency provisions (extent to be checked)	Gate 2, week 1–6
U12	Grid-services value of the site (inertia, voltage support) post-blackout regulation — could a large flexible load be an asset REE wants here?	COMMERCIAL	REE dialogue; regulatory watch on post-April-2025 stability rules	Gate 2–3

Reading: four unknowns (U1, U2, U3, U11) are gate-blocking in the strict sense. All four are resolvable by correspondence and registry work measured in weeks and low thousands of euros — the defining feature of a location worth continued research rather than either advancement or rejection.

17. Evidence Register

Every load-bearing claim of the dossier, its classification, source, source date, and the desk's confidence in the claim as stated. "Via" marks primary acts retrieved through secondary carriage: the original must be pulled at Gate 2 (Section 18 lists the pull queue).

Claim	Class	Source	Date	Conf.
Coal plant: four units totalling 1,468 MW; plus 800 MW CCGT on the complex	VERIFIED	Wikipedia (ES) corroborated by Grupo Resa project note and Endesa environmental declaration	various	High
Coal production ceased October 2023; full closure authorised 2023 (BOE-A-2023-18538 cited)	PARTIALLY VERIFIED	elEconomista (Jul 2026); Wikipedia citing BOE — BOE original not pulled	2023/2026	High
Four cooling towers demolished by controlled blast, late July 2026; land destined to industrial uses; Ence plant (€355M plan) among announced projects	VERIFIED	elEconomista	Jul 2026	High
Puentes G.R. 400 kV access capacity null; Maciñeira 400 kV added to Planning 2021–2026 by modification	VERIFIED	Council of Ministers agreement via COPE / elEconomista / GaliciaPress	14 Apr 2026	High
Maciñeira declared just-transition node 14 Apr 2026; concurso to award access to renewables and storage; consultation open, submissions to 19 May 2026	VERIFIED	MITECO press release; pv magazine; Smartgridsinfo	Apr 2026	High
Just-transition zone = 14 named municipalities (11 A Coruña + 3 Lugo)	VERIFIED	MITECO / pv magazine / Smartgridsinfo (concordant)	Apr 2026	High
Meirama 220 kV: 408 MW provisionally awarded to Coventina Renovables (pumped hydro, ~€250M)	VERIFIED	MITECO / ITJ	2026	High
Concurso scoring: socioeconomic criteria incl. surplus coal workers, training, self-consumption, associated industrial projects (mechanism per RD-I 23/2020 as referenced)	PARTIALLY VERIFIED	transicionjusta.gob.es (ITJ)	current	Med-High
Endesa CEO (Feb 2026) proposes As Pontes for data centers: land, connections, renewables; PPA-anchor framing; regulatory-uncertainty caveat	VERIFIED	DataCenterDynamics ES; galiciae interview reference	Feb 2026	High
>43 GW national demand-access rights granted since 2020; 2024 peak 38.2 GW; draft planning: 27.7 GW demand from transmission incl. 3.8 GW data centers; €13.59bn transmission capex; Galician new-consumption capacity ≈ 2× the 2.2 GW regional peak	VERIFIED (as reported; plan is draft)	MITECO figures via Energías Renovables and Conecta Industria	2025–2026	Med-High

Claim	Class	Source	Date	Conf.
RD-L 7/2026 (20 Mar 2026, in force 22 Mar) reformed demand-access rules to curb hoarding	VERIFIED	GA_P legal note on RD-L 7/2026	Mar 2026	High
CNMC: 6.58% network remuneration 2026–2031; 0.13% GDP remunerable-investment cap retained	VERIFIED (as reported)	Conecta Industria citing CNMC (Dec 2025)	Dec 2025	Medium
UFD (Naturgy) to invest €520M in Galician networks to 2029 (42% of national grid plan)	VERIFIED	Conecta Industria	Jun 2026	Medium-High
Lake: 865 ha; ~5 km; 206 m max depth; filling water balance (~96/21/24 hm³/yr); connection to Eume at level 332; ~2,000 quality controls/yr; filled in ~3.7 years	VERIFIED (dated)	El Correo Gallego (2010); El Progreso (2011)	2010–11	Medium
Eume reservoir 123 hm³ (dam 101 m × 284 m, 1955–60); A Ribeira 33 hm³; Eume river ~80 km from Serra do Xistral to ría de Ares	VERIFIED	Concello de Pontedeume; EumeVivo	current	High
Ence: ~100,000 t/yr recycled fibre; captures ~5,000 m³/day from the lake; ~1.55 hm³/yr wastewater; favourable DIA from Xunta; ADEGA contests compliance with Galicia-Costa 2021–2027 standards; dilution-to-Eume proposal	VERIFIED	TerraChaXa reporting DIA + ADEGA	2025–26	Med-High
Fragas do Eume: 9,125 ha; declared 1997; ZEC; <500 residents; partly within As Pontes; 2012 fire burned 750 ha	VERIFIED	Concello de Pontedeume; Wikipedia (EN) citing Europa Press	various	High
1953 water concession predating ecological-flow obligations; 2010 ecological-flow controversy on a 3.4 km Eume stretch	VERIFIED (historical)	El Correo Gallego (2010, quoting conselleiro and Endesa)	2010	Medium
Curtis: Galicia Green Data Center — first Galician DC; Tier III; 15 MW IT; >40,000 m²; >€50M (phase 1 €37M); PIE status; Impulsa Galicia + Ingenostrum	VERIFIED	DataCenterDynamics ES	2025–26	High
Nostrum/JLL: six Spanish DCs, 800 MW planned (500 IT + 300 reserve), operational through 2027, supply and land described as secured	VERIFIED (announcement)	CdeComunicación	Jan 2026	Medium
Sines: EllaLink + Medusa landings; Start Campus planned 495 MW hub	VERIFIED	IEEE.es strategic paper	2023	Medium-High
Endesa Termic chimney: 356 m, built 1974, second tallest in Europe	VERIFIED	Wikipedia (EN)	—	Medium-High
BNG campaign to preserve towers/chimney/halls as museum; demolition proceeded	VERIFIED	elEconomista	Jul 2026	High
Demand capacity available for a data center at this node	EVIDENCE REQUIRED	No source found — the central gap	—	—
Fibre backbone, carriers, redundancy at the site	UNKNOWN	No source found after targeted search	—	—

Claim	Class	Source	Date	Conf.
DSO identity at parcel; INE code; rail status; flood mapping; heritage listing; AEMET normals; CCGT status; parcel data	EVIDENCE REQUIRED	Retrieval paths defined in Sections 16 / Appendix B	—	—
All coordinates and road distances in Section 3	HYPOTHESIS (approximate)	Public mapping/gazetteer; tolerances stated inline	2026	Medium

18. Sources

18.1 Sources used in this pass

Listed individually, per Atlas policy. Where a primary act was accessed through secondary carriage, the primary is named in 18.2 as a pull-queue item.

ID	Source	Class
S1	MITECO — press release: “El MITECO inicia la tramitación del concurso de transición justa de As Pontes”, 23 Apr 2026 (miteco.gob.es)	Primary
S2	Instituto para la Transición Justa — “Nudos de transición justa” programme page (transicionjusta.gob.es)	Primary
S3	Council of Ministers agreement designating Maciñeira 400 kV a just-transition node, 14 Apr 2026 — as carried by COPE Galicia, elEconomista and GaliciaPress	Primary act, secondary carriage
S4	Smartgridsinfo — consultation detail on the Maciñeira concurso (24 Apr 2026), incl. 19 May 2026 deadline	Secondary
S5	pv magazine España — “MITECO inicia la tramitación...” (24 Apr 2026), incl. 14-municipality zone list	Secondary
S6	GA_P (Gómez-Acebo & Pombo) — legal analysis of RD-L 7/2026 grid-access measures (Mar 2026)	Secondary (statute primary)
S7	DataCenterDynamics ES — “Endesa propone As Pontes como polo gallego para grandes centros de datos” (CEO Bogas statements, Feb 2026)	Secondary
S8	elEconomista — cooling-tower demolition report (late Jul 2026): plant history, 1,468 MW, Oct-2023 cessation, Ence €355M, BNG heritage campaign	Secondary
S9	Energías Renovables — “La demanda de electricidad en Galicia se va a duplicar...” (Sep/Oct 2025): MITECO draft-planning figures	Secondary
S10	Conecta Industria — UFD €520M Galician plan; national demand-access and planning figures; CNMC Dec-2025 parameters (Jun 2026)	Secondary
S11	TerraChaXa — Ence As Pontes DIA and ADEGA objections (abstraction, discharge, Galicia-Costa standards)	Secondary
S12	El Correo Gallego (Jan 2010) — lake dimensions (865 ha, 206 m), 1953 concession and ecological-flow controversy	Secondary, dated
S13	El Progreso (Mar 2011) — lake filling water balance (96/21/24 hm ³ /yr; 3,335 m canal; level 332; ~2,000 controls/yr)	Secondary, dated
S14	Concello de Pontedeume — Fragas do Eume page: park 9,125 ha; reservoirs A Ribeira 33 hm ³ and Eume 123 hm ³	Secondary/official-municipal
S15	EumeVivo — Eume dam data (101 m / 284 m; 1955–60; most powerful hydro plant of the province)	Secondary
S16	Wikipedia (EN) — Fragas do Eume (1997 declaration; 2012 fire, 750 ha, citing Europa Press); Endesa Termic (356 m chimney, 1974); As Pontes municipality	Tertiary, background only
S17	Wikipedia (ES) — Central térmica de Puentes de García Rodríguez (1,468 MW + 800 MW CCGT; closure chronology; BOE-A-2023-18538 citation)	Tertiary, background only
S18	DataCenterDynamics ES — “Galicia se estrena en el mapa de los centros de datos...” (Curtis project, PIE status)	Secondary
S19	CdeComunicación — Nostrum/JLL six-site 800 MW announcement (Jan 2026)	Secondary

ID	Source	Class
S20	IEEE.es (Instituto Español de Estudios Estratégicos) — “España en la red global de cables submarinos” (Dec 2023): Sines/Sesimbra landings; Start Campus 495 MW	Secondary/institutional
S21	Grupo Resa — As Pontes desulphurisation project note (plant configuration corroboration)	Secondary
S22	Endesa — Declaración Ambiental 2021, CTCC As Pontes (CCGT existence, shared infrastructure, 1976 start of the coal plant)	Primary (2021)
S23	Amigos de As Pontes — cooling-towers-to-data-center essay (Jun 2026): local climate claims; used only as a labelled partisan source	Tertiary/advocacy

18.2 Primary-document pull queue for Gate 2

- BOE — closure authorisation of the As Pontes thermal plant (reference BOE-A-2023-18538 to be confirmed against the gazette).
- BOE — Royal Decree-Law 7/2026 full text and any implementing orders.
- BOE — Council of Ministers agreement of 14 Apr 2026 (Maciñeira designation) and the planning-modification order incorporating Maciñeira 400 kV.
- MITECO — consultation file and, when published, the ministerial order with the Maciñeira concurso bases (incl. MW volume).
- MITECO/REE — Planificación 2026/2030: final approved text and Galician annexes; REE demand-capacity publications for the A Coruña 400 kV nodes.
- DOG — Ence As Pontes DIA full text (quality-standard reasoning is the template for any Atlas water file).
- Plan Hidrológico Galicia-Costa 2021–2027 — Eume body objectives, flows and drought indicators; successor-cycle drafts if published.
- Catastro & Registro de la Propiedad — parcel data over the released platforms.
- PXOM de As Pontes via SIOTUGA — zoning of the envelope.
- AEMET — station normals and hourly series for the district; MeteoGalicia records.
- MITECO SNCZI — flood cartography for the Eume/lake system.
- CNMC — Dec 2025 remuneration resolution; access/connection circular as amended.

19. Final Recommendation

19.1 The three permitted answers

Option	Decision	Reasoning
Reject	NO	Rejection requires an evidenced fatal flaw. None is yet evidenced: demand capacity is undetermined (not determined-zero); land is unallocated (not unavailable); the water conflict constrains design (it does not exclude the site); no protected-area overlap of the industrial envelope itself was found. Rejecting now would discard a potentially rare asset on the basis of an information gap Atlas can close for the cost of correspondence.
Advance to next gate	NO	Advancement requires the core thesis to survive first contact with primary evidence. It has not: the only capacity instruments in the public record run the wrong way (access declared null; new capacity auctioned to generation), and every affirmative signal traces to the commercially interested incumbent. Advancing on promotional statements would violate the Atlas standard this dossier exists to enforce.
Continue researching	YES	The site presents a rare combination of verified structural assets (400 kV yards in situ, state-sponsored capacity-creation machinery with a live concurso, an 865 ha / 206 m-deep heat sink, released industrial land at scale, a fast-track permitting precedent, cool Atlantic air) alongside four gate-blocking unknowns (U1, U2, U3, U11), each resolvable in weeks by formal enquiry and registry work. Buying that information is cheap; both alternative decisions are premature.

19.2 Binary advancement condition

Atlas advances As Pontes to Gate 2 sign-off if and only if it obtains written confirmation from Red Eléctrica — or an equivalent MITECO planning document — of non-zero demand connection capacity, or a credible allocation pathway, of at least 100 MW at Puentes G.R. 400 kV / Maciñeira 400 kV within a defined horizon compatible with a 2029–2031 energisation. A documented answer of “no capacity and none planned” triggers rejection, recorded as a successful research outcome. Ambiguous answers extend research with a 90-day re-decision clock.

19.3 Spend and conduct rules until then

- Expenditure limited to the Appendix B workplan (enquiries, registries, RFIs, meetings); no land options, exclusivities, or engineering commissions.
- Two independent entry routes kept alive at all times (public route: planning/concurso/public land; bilateral route: Endesa) to prevent counterparty lock-in (R9).
- No external communication of interest in the site: the demand-access environment (R5, RD-L 7/2026) punishes visible speculative interest, and land pricing responds to signalled demand.
- This dossier to be re-issued as v2.0 upon receipt of the REE answer, the concurso bases, or approval of the Planificación — whichever comes first.

End of main report. Appendices follow.

Appendix A — Regulatory & Institutional Framework

Purpose: one place where every legal instrument touching this site is named, with its role and verification status. Instruments marked “to confirm” are cited from secondary or institutional sources and must be pulled from BOE/DOG at Gate 2.

A.1 Electricity and grid access

Instrument	Role for this project	Status
Ley 24/2013 del Sector Eléctrico	Framework statute: access and connection rights, planning, closures	[HYPOTHESIS] (standard framework; confirm current consolidated text)
RD 1183/2020 (access & connection)	Procedure for access/connection permits, incl. demand	[HYPOTHESIS] (standard; confirm as amended)
CNMC access circular	Detailed access rules and capacity calculation	[EVIDENCE REQUIRED] (pull current version)
RD-I 23/2020	Creates just-transition node concursos (per ITJ programme page)	[PARTIALLY VERIFIED] — number to confirm on BOE
RD-Law 7/2026 (20 Mar 2026)	Re-regulates demand access to curb hoarding; governs any Atlas application	[VERIFIED] via legal note; pull BOE
Planificación Eléctrica 2021–2026 (as modified)	Contains the Maciñeira 400 kV incorporation	[VERIFIED] (modification's existence); pull the order
Planificación 2026/2030 (draft)	Source of the Galician demand-capacity outlook and the 3.8 GW national data-center figure	[VERIFIED] as draft; approval pending — U7
CNMC Dec-2025 remuneration resolution	6.58% rate; 0.13% GDP investment cap — reinforcement pace	[VERIFIED] as reported; pull resolution

A.2 Environment, water and land

Instrument	Role	Status
Ley 21/2013 de evaluación ambiental (state) / Galician EIA regime	EIA/DIA pathway; the Ence DIA shows the Xunta exercising this competence at this site	[PARTIALLY VERIFIED]
Natura 2000 (Habitats Directive) — ZEC Fragas do Eume	Appropriate assessment for anything affecting the Eume system	[VERIFIED]
Plan Hidrológico Galicia-Costa 2021–2027	Water-body objectives and quality standards; the benchmark invoked against Ence	[VERIFIED] (existence & use); pull Eume sheets
1953 Eume concession (Endesa)	Historic water right whose current status governs lake abstraction	[VERIFIED] (existence, via 2010 reporting); current status [EVIDENCE REQUIRED]
Galician land law & PXOM de As Pontes	Zoning of the envelope; licence basis	[EVIDENCE REQUIRED]
Xunta “strategic industrial project” (PIE) figure	Fast-track: priority processing of urbanistic, environmental and sectoral files (exercised for the Curtis DC)	[VERIFIED] (effect); statute cite to confirm

Instrument	Role	Status
Soil-quality / contaminated-land regime	Condition of coal-yard and ash-handling platforms	[EVIDENCE REQUIRED]

A.3 Institutions map

Institution	Why Atlas will interact with it
Red Eléctrica (Redeia)	Demand access enquiry and application; transmission mapping; (via Reintel) possibly fibre
MITECO / Secretaría de Estado de Energía	Planning allocations; closure files; node designations
Instituto para la Transición Justa	Maciñeira concurso bases and calendar; association route
CNMC	Access rules; disputes; infrastructure registry (fibre/ducts)
Xunta de Galicia (energy, industry — Igape, environment, urbanism)	PIE status; DIA; zoning instruments; incentives
Augas de Galicia	Abstraction and discharge; drought indicators; hydrological plan
Concello de As Pontes	PXOM, licences, local politics, municipal land
Endesa	Land, legacy assets, lake handover data, PPAs, its own scheme
UFD (Naturgy)	If any distribution-level supply or construction power is needed
Autoridad Portuaria Ferrol-San Cibrao / ADIF / road administration	Heavy-haul logistics
AEMET / MeteoGalicia / IGN / Catastro / INE	Baseline datasets

Appendix B — Gate 2 Workplan

Twelve-week formal-enquiry programme. Budget class: correspondence, registry fees, travel and advisory hours only — no commitments. Deliverable of the programme: dossier v2.0 with the binary condition of Section 19.2 answered.

WS	Workstream / tasks	Weeks	Deliverable	Kills project if...
WS1	GRID (owner: power lead). Draft and send REE demand enquiry (C1); pull REE demand-capacity maps; pull planning-modification order (Maciñeira); map queue transparency under RD-L 7/2026; meet REE regional delegation if offered.	1–6	Written REE position on demand MW & horizon; queue picture (U1, U11, U8)	“No capacity, none planned” in writing
WS2	LAND (owner: land lead). Catastro extraction over the envelope; nota simple on key parcels; PXOM/SIOTUGA zoning; soil-quality file requests; identify municipal/Xunta land alternatives.	1–8	Parcel book with ownership, zoning, constraints (U2)	All viable parcels controlled and refused
WS3	WATER (owner: environment lead). Pull Ence DIA (DOG); Galicia-Costa Eume sheets; pre-application meeting with Augas de Galicia on lake-loop and dry options; request Endesa lake-monitoring handover data.	2–10	Water opinion: permissible cooling envelope (U3)	Authority excludes all abstraction and heat-rejection options
WS4	FIBRE (owner: network lead). RFIs to Reintel, Lyntia, Telefónica wholesale (C4); CNMC infrastructure registry; TeleGeography check on Galician landings.	2–10	Connectivity memo: routes, diversity, budgetary build cost (U4)	Single-route only at prohibitive build cost (downgrades, rarely kills)
WS5	COUNTERPARTIES & POLITICS (owner: project director). Meetings: Endesa transition/real-estate team; Concello; Xunta/Igape; ITJ on association route; track concurso bases publication (U9).	3–12	Counterparty map; PIE feasibility note; route decision A–D (U5, U9, U10)	Both entry routes formally closed
WS6	BASELINES (owner: engineering). AEMET/MeteoGalicia data purchase; SNCZI flood layers; PLADIGA wildfire stats; IGN seismic; desk geotech from dismantling EIA.	2–12	Site basis-of-design datasheet v0 (U6)	— (informs design, cannot kill at this stage)
WS7	REGULATORY WATCH (owner: legal). BOE pull-queue of Section 18.2; monitor Planificación approval (U7) and RD-L 7/2026 secondary rules; log changes weekly.	1–12	Living regulatory log; v2.0 legal annex	Planning approved with zero NW-Galicia demand allocation (combined with WS1 negative)

Decision protocol at week 12

The desk convenes on the earlier of (a) receipt of the REE written position or (b) week 12. Outcomes: ADVANCE if Section 19.2's condition is met and WS2/WS3 show at least one uncontrolled-fatal-flaw-free parcel and one permissible cooling concept; REJECT on any “kills” trigger above; otherwise CONTINUE with a named 90-day clock and a written statement of exactly which evidence is still missing.

Appendix C — Formal Enquiry Templates

Drafting notes: templates are deliberately information-seeking, not application-making, to avoid triggering guarantee obligations or signalling speculative demand (Risk R5). Send in Spanish; English drafts below for desk review.

C1 — Demand-access enquiry to Red Eléctrica

Addressee: REE access & connection unit (demand), copy regional delegation. Substance:

- We are evaluating a large electro-intensive industrial demand facility (initial phase 100–300 MW, scalable) in the municipality of As Pontes de García Rodríguez (A Coruña).
- Question 1: What demand connection capacity, if any, is currently available or foreseen at the Puentes de García Rodríguez 400 kV and Maciñeira 400 kV substations, and on what horizon?
- Question 2: Which procedure and documentation apply to a demand access request at these nodes following RD-Law 7/2026, and what guarantees and milestones would attach?
- Question 3: Are there existing demand access requests or permits at these nodes that would rank ahead of a new application (to the extent disclosable)?
- Question 4: Does the draft Planificación 2026/2030 contemplate demand-serving reinforcements at or near these nodes, and how would approval affect Questions 1–3?
- Question 5: Whom should we address for a pre-application technical meeting?

C2 — Land & cadastral due-diligence checklist

- Define the envelope polygon (plant platforms; adjacent estates; Ence-excluded areas) on cadastral cartography; extract every parcel reference within it.
- For each parcel: ownership (nota simple), surface, charges, leases, mining-concession reversion clauses, expropriation history annotations.
- PXOM classification and permitted uses; any pending modification or sectoral plan affecting the envelope; PIE eligibility screen.
- Soil-quality declarations and remediation obligations for former coal, ash and fuel areas; demolition-project conditions surviving on the land.
- Utility easements: 400 kV line corridors, the 3,335 m Eume–lake canal, pipelines, and the lake-level (332) hydraulic servitudes.

C3 — Augas de Galicia pre-application brief

- Describe two cooling concepts only: (i) closed-loop with heat rejection to the lake (withdraw/return, net evaporative loss stated); (ii) dry cooling with municipal supply for domestic loads. Explicitly exclude river discharge from the concepts presented.
- Ask: current legal regime of the lake and of the 1953 concession post-closure; whether heat rejection to the lake is concessionable and under what assessment; applicable Galicia-Costa objectives for the lake body; drought-indicator exposure of any abstraction.
- Request the lake's monitoring record (or its holder's identity) and any thermal- or quality-modelling done for the Ence file that reads across.

C4 — Fibre RFI skeleton (Reintel / Lyntia / Telefónica wholesale)

- Presence: routes and access points within 15 km of As Pontes town; product (dark fibre / spectrum / waves) and spare capacity class.
- Diversity: physically disjoint second route options and their nearest join-points.
- Reach: route-miles and indicative latency to Madrid ecosystems; onward options toward Portugal (Sines) and the Bay of Biscay landings.
- Build: budgetary cost and lead time for a new lateral from the nearest access point to the envelope; wayleave posture along the 400 kV corridor.
- No volumes or dates disclosed; frame as feasibility screening for an industrial campus.

Appendix D — Glossary & Abbreviations

Term	Meaning
ADEGA	Asociación para a Defensa Ecolóxica de Galiza — Galician environmental NGO, active opponent in the Ence file.
AEMET	Spanish state meteorological agency; source of climate normals.
AG-64	Galician autonomous autovía understood to serve As Pontes toward Ferrol (classification in Section 11).
ARPSI	Áreas de Riesgo Potencial Significativo de Inundación — official flood-risk areas under the EU Floods Directive.
BNG	Bloque Nacionalista Galego — Galician political party; heritage campaign at the plant.
BOE / DOG	State and Galician official gazettes.
CCGT	Combined-cycle gas turbine (the 800 MW unit at the complex).
CNMC	Comisión Nacional de los Mercados y la Competencia — regulator for energy and telecoms.
Concurso	Public competitive award; here, the just-transition capacity auction.
DIA	Declaración de Impacto Ambiental — environmental impact declaration closing an EIA.
DSO / TSO	Distribution / Transmission System Operator.
Fragas do Eume	Atlantic riparian forest natural park (9,125 ha, 1997) and Natura 2000 ZEC along the Eume downstream of the site.
hm³	Cubic hectometre = 1 million m ³ .
Igape	Galician economic development agency.
INE	Spanish national statistics institute.
ITJ	Instituto para la Transición Justa (MITECO) — administers node concursos.
MITECO	Ministry for the Ecological Transition and the Demographic Challenge.
Nudo de transición justa	Grid node whose freed access capacity is awarded by concurso with socioeconomic scoring.
OPGW	Optical ground wire — fibre embedded in transmission earth wire; basis of Reintel's network.
PIE	Proyecto Industrial Estratégico — Xunta fast-track status (exercised for the Curtis DC).
PLADIGA	Galician wildfire prevention and defence plan (statistics source).
PPA	Power purchase agreement.
PXOM	Plan Xeral de Ordenación Municipal — municipal master plan.
REE / Redeia	Red Eléctrica de España, the TSO, within the Redeia group (which also owns Reintel fibre).
RFQ / RFI	Request for quotation / information.
SIOTUGA	Xunta urban-planning information system.
SNCZI	National flood-zone cartography system (MITECO).
UDC / USC / UVigo	Universities of A Coruña, Santiago de Compostela and Vigo.
UFD	Naturgy's distribution utility, dominant DSO in Galicia.
ZEC	Zona de Especial Conservación — Special Area of Conservation (Natura 2000).

End of dossier. Prepared for internal Atlas use; AI-assisted; human review required before external circulation. All classifications reflect the evidence available on 4 August 2026 and expire upon receipt of any Gate 2 primary document.

Appendix E — Assumption Ledger (Hypotheses Under Test)

Every statement classified Hypothesis in the body of this dossier, consolidated with its falsification test. Atlas treats an untested hypothesis older than one gate cycle as expired: it must be re-verified or downgraded. This ledger is the v2.0 checklist.

#	Hypothesis (section)	Falsification / verification test
H1	Town-centre and asset coordinates as tabulated, tolerances ± 500 m–1 km (§3.2)	Replace with Catastro / REE / IGN survey coordinates
H2	Road distances: Ferrol ≈ 35 –45 km; A Coruña ≈ 60 –75 km; Santiago ≈ 90 –110 km; Madrid ecosystems ≈ 550 –600 km (§3.3)	Routing-engine verification; carrier route-miles for the Madrid figure
H3	Town elevation ≈ 300 –350 m (§3.4)	IGN elevation model
H4	Population $\approx 10,000$ (§3.1)	INE municipal register, latest year
H5	Endesa (or group) holds most released land (§4.2)	Registro de la Propiedad notas simples over the envelope
H6	Penapurreira industrial estate exists as candidate overflow land (§4.1)	PXOM / Xunta industrial-land inventory
H7	UFD is the DSO at the parcels (§6.1)	UFD network map / supply-point query
H8	CCGT commissioned ≈ 2008 (§5.2)	Endesa filings; MITECO authorisation
H9	Concurso-association and planning-allocation entry routes (B, C) are legally available to a demand facility (§6.5)	Concurso bases when published; legal opinion on planning allocations
H10	Galician wind pipeline can supply anchor PPAs at competitive terms (§7.2, 7.4)	Named-project pipeline compilation; indicative PPA quotes
H11	Lake-loop heat rejection is physically attractive given 206 m depth and thermal mass (§8.4)	Limnological / thermal-stratification study; Augas de Galicia pre-application response
H12	Dry-cooling economics are favourable in this climate (§8.4, §12.1)	AEMET hourly series $\rightarrow$ free-cooling-hours model
H13	Drought exposure prima facie low (§8.5)	Galicia-Costa drought indicators for the Eume system
H14	Dark fibre follows the 400 kV and motorway corridors; Madrid is the relevant ecosystem; training workloads tolerate the latency (§9.3)	Reintel/Lyntia/Telefónica RFI responses; measured latency
H15	Archaeological constraint on reclaimed land is low (§10.3)	Xunta heritage service screening
H16	Seismicity low in national terms (§10.4, §12.3)	IGN / NCSE hazard maps
H17	Made-ground geotechnics adverse until proven (conservative) (§10.4)	Dismantling-project geotech records; Gate 3 site investigation
H18	AG-64 gives dual-carriageway access toward Ferrol/AP-9; abnormal-load route to the complex existed and can be re-established (§11.1–11.2)	Road inventory; transport survey for transformer-class loads
H19	No active rail service to As Pontes; nearest railheads Ferrol area (§11.3)	ADIF network statement

#	Hypothesis (section)	Falsification / verification test
H20	Airport distances as stated (§11.4)	Routing verification
H21	Summer peaks well below interior-Iberian values; high free-cooling share (§12.1)	AEMET design-condition percentiles
H22	Ferrolterra industrial labour (incl. naval) commutable; housing available in town; strong political appetite for incomers (§13.1, 13.3)	Commuting-zone statistics; INE housing census; Concello meetings
H23	Power-plant O&M; skills partially transferable to DC operations (§13.2)	Skills mapping against reference DC staffing plan
H24	No cloud region exists in Galicia; AWS region in Aragón; Madrid hosts the hyperscale cluster (§14.3)	Provider region lists (trivial check)
H25	A data center scores modestly on concurso jobs criteria versus other industry (§10.5)	Scoring grid in published bases; comparator analysis
H26	Atlas' relative position in Eume assimilative-capacity queue is weaker than Ence's (§8.3)	Augas de Galicia response; only relevant if any river discharge is ever contemplated

Ledger rule

At each dossier re-issue, every row must move to Verified, Refuted (with consequence noted), or carry a dated extension approved by the project director. Hypotheses do not age into facts.

Document History & Sign-off

Version	Date	Change	Author	Review
0.1	4 Aug 2026	Research pass and conversational summary	Atlas Research Desk (AI-assisted)	—
1.0	4 Aug 2026	Full Gate 1 dossier issued (this document)	Atlas Research Desk (AI-assisted)	Pending human review
2.0	planned	Re-issue on REE written position, concurso bases, or Planificación approval — whichever first (§19.3)	—	—

Sign-off conditions for v1.0

- Human reviewer to spot-check every Verified claim against the cited source before any external circulation.
- Section 18.2 pull-queue to be opened as tracked tasks before Gate 2 correspondence is sent.
- No excerpt of this dossier to be shared with counterparties; enquiry templates in Appendix C are the only outward-facing artefacts.

Project director	Signature: _____	Date: _____
Research lead	Signature: _____	Date: _____
Legal reviewer	Signature: _____	Date: _____